there is good and useful material, we are not given any proper appreciation of Antiochene theology as a whole. In fact, when Fr. Montalverne is writing of matters not immediately connected with Theodoret himself he makes strange statements. For example, on pages 48 and 50 he ascribes to Marius Mercator the excerpts from Theodoret's *Pentalogus* preserved in what Schwartz called the *Collectio Palatina*. This collection of documents certainly used to be regarded as the work of Marius Mercator. But it was conclusively proved by Schwartz that the material contributed by Marius Mercator was only the nucleus of the collection, which was made during the sixth century with an eye to the controversy concerning the Three Chapters. The excerpts from Theodoret do not occur in that section of the Palatine Collection which is derived from Marius Mercator. Further, on page 53, we are told that of Theodoret's *ep.* 173 we have only a fragment in the Latin version of Marius Mercator. The fragment is preserved in Latin in the Palatine Collection in the part not derived from Mercator. And the whole letter survives in another Latin translation in the *Collectio Casinensis* 227, where also the correct form of address is found.

H. CHADWICK

La formazione teologica di Sant'Agostino, By ALBERTO PINCHERLE. Pp. 207. Rome: Edizioni Italiane, n.d. Lire 650.

THE contrast between the earlier writings of St. Augustine and those later works, in which is set forth the theology of grace and predestination historically associated with his name and destined to have such profound effects upon later theological controversies, is a phenomenon which has attracted attention, especially in recent times. It lies behind the sharp dispute, early in this century, over the thesis of Gourdon and Alfaric, who held that he was converted to Neoplatonism rather than to Christianity in 386 and did not become a Christian in the proper sense until later; for their case rests partly upon an identification of his earlier thought with a Neoplatonic pseudo-Christianity. That there is a contrast is clear to the most superficial reader; it is not so easy to define in what it consists. But the most interesting problem of all is the question of the influences which dictated the passage of Augustine's thought from the humanistic and intellectualist outlook upon religion of the early Dialogues to the transcendental, theocentric type of thought which is characteristic of the developed theologian. It is to this problem that Signor Pincherle has devoted himself in a book which explores the thought of Augustine, especially upon the matter of grace and human freewill, from the time of his conversion to the appearance of the *Confessions*, *c.* 397. The work is the result of long studies,

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pursued since 1930 and earlier, which are described in the preface. The author has been much hindered by his forced exile from Italy, which he spent partly in South America, and the consequent difficulty of obtaining books and periodicals; his persistence in his quest forms a fascinating story of scholarship maintained in the disordered conditions of our time.

Pincherle's method is to examine closely Augustine's treatment of the vital questions upon which his thought changed and developed in the various writings which belong to the period studied. He accompanies his discussion with copious notes, which both print the most significant passages and refer to most of the important modern studies of Augustine. (It is unfortunate that the author has followed a bad and all too prevalent custom of printing these notes separately from his text, which makes his book unnecessarily difficult to handle.) His treatment is thorough and judicious and free from dogmatism, though he has a very definite thesis to propound. He is dissatisfied both with the theory of Augustine as a mere Neoplatonist at the time of his conversion and with the view of Buonaiuti, his former teacher, who thought that Augustine derived his doctrine of original sin, and so of grace, from Ambrosiaster, under the ultimate influence of the dualism of his Manichaean days. Pincherle, on the other hand, attributes Augustine's gradual change of outlook chiefly to his more intensive study of Scripture, and especially of St. Paul (of which we hear in the well-known letter to Valerius, *Ep.* xxi), after his ordination to the priesthood, while a good case is stated for the view that upon one vital matter, which influenced greatly his doctrine of grace, Augustine's mentor was not Ambrosiaster, but Tyconius, the Donatist. For Tyconius taught that the faith by which we are justified is solely the gift of God and referred to 1 Cor. 4[1] in support of his view that no man can take any credit for his own salvation.[1] And it is precisely this text from 1 Cor. to which Augustine attributes, in *Retractationes*, ii. 1, his conversion to the idea that faith is the gift of God. Ambrosiaster, as Pincherle shows (pp. 183–4), does not so explain this text. Our author meets the objection that Augustine does not, in the passage cited from the *Retractations*, refer to Tyconius, but to Cyprian, as the author who drew his attention to the verse, by pointing out that Cyprian merely cites the passage in his *Testimonia* (III. 4), with a general heading '*In nullo gloriandum, quando nostrum nihil est*', whereas Tyconius actually uses it in his argument. Cyprian's mere mention of the passage, it is suggested, would not have been enough by itself to change Augustine's attitude in so important

[1] *Liber Regularum*, ed. F. C. Burkitt, Texts and Studies, vol. iii (Cambridge, 1894), p. 19.

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a matter. This smacks a little of special pleading, but Pincherle is on stronger ground when he argues that, though we know that Augustine was greatly influenced by Tyconius, it would not have been safe for him to use this writer as an authority against the Pelagians, who would have objected that he was a Donatist and so a heretic. We can therefore explain St. Augustine's silence about the influence of Tyconius upon his doctrine of grace (p. 187 f.).

Whatever may be thought of this argument, Pincherle has done good service in pointing out the difficulties in the theory that Ambrosiaster is the originator of the later Augustinian theology (pp. 182 ff.). His argument cannot easily be summarized, but repays study. He does not deny all influence of Ambrosiaster upon the Doctor of Grace, but declares roundly that 'To Ambrosiaster Augustine was not directly a debtor, either for the theory of the transmission of original sin in the full sense of the term, or for the other doctrines connected with this' (p. 184). In view of the currency given to a modified form of the opposite view by the late Dr. N. P. Williams in England,[1] these criticisms deserve study by English readers.

In fact the chief value of Pincherle's work is that it refuses to accept any simple or easy explanation of Augustine's theological development, attributing it not to any one single factor, but to the progressive study of Scripture and the Christian Fathers which caused the convert rhetorician-philosopher of Milan to develop into a theologian who steadily set more store by revelation and less by natural human reason. He presents the story as one of logical progress with few abrupt changes. In particular he scouts psychological explanations of the saint, such as the supposed influence of his former Manichaean dualism upon his view of sin and grace (pp. 188 ff.), showing the differences between Augustine's idea of mankind as a *massa peccati* and the Manichaean conception of the βῶλος, though he does not deny that Augustine's own experiences helped him to arrive at his final position (pp. 128 and 159–61). He does well too to draw our attention to the modifications necessitated by the work of Courcelle[2] of the still widespread view that Augustine's knowledge of Greek was absolutely negligible; the Greek Fathers were by no means wholly closed books to him and Greek theology had its effect upon his development (p. 179 f.), even though his efforts to deepen his knowledge of the language belong to a later period than that with which this book deals.

Pincherle's book is a most valuable contribution to Augustinian

[1] *The Ideas of the Fall and of Original Sin* (London, 1927), pp. 307–10, 327–30, 379.

[2] *Les lettres grecques en Occident*, (Paris, 1948), pp. 137–94.

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studies, summing up as it does a long progress of thought on the part of its author, who makes clear that he has been led by his reading to reject views which have lately become widespread and were formerly held by himself. For this reason, and because it is partly based upon a full acquaintance with the voluminous recent work, largely continental, upon Augustine, it is to be hoped that it will have a wide circulation in this country. It would well repay translation for the benefit of those who do not read Italian. THOMAS M. PARKER

An Early Euchologion. By C. H. ROBERTS and Dom B. CAPELLE. Pp. 72 + 6 plates (*Bibliothèque du Muséon,* vol. 23), Louvain, 1949.

THE 'Dêr-Balizeh Papyrus' has long deserved such an edition as this. It is of great importance for the study of liturgy and of the creeds; yet there has been hitherto no text which the student could readily purchase. Furthermore, it now appears that all previous editions have ignored a substantial part of the material in the frame which bears the mark MS. Gr. Lit.d.2–4 (P) in the Bodleian Library, Oxford.

The present edition contains an introduction, a transcription with *apparatus criticus* by Mr. Roberts, and parallel passages furnished by Dom Capelle. The latter also supplies twenty-three pages of liturgical commentary; and there are excellent indexes. The half-tone plates are at first sight disappointing by comparison with those given by Dom Puniet in the *Revue bénédictine*, which suggest something of the appearance of papyrus; but they are admirably clear.

Students of the creeds will be relieved to know that the present editors add nothing to the text of the creed in the papyrus. Students of liturgy, on the other hand, will rejoice to find the eucharistic prayer substantially complete. Mr. Roberts has succeeded in fitting into place almost all the unrecorded fragments which he found in the frame. The result is a eucharistic prayer with an important new feature in common with Serapion. This is a passage praying that as the bread which was scattered upon the hills has become one so may the Church be gathered into one. This petition of course links the papyrus not only with Serapion but also with the prayers of the *Didache*. And the three texts are usefully set out and discussed in the commentary.

Two omissions from the book should be noted. The first (of minor importance) is that the bibliography does not mention Dom Puniet's paper given to the Eucharistic Congress held at Westminster in 1908. The text published in this paper, which occupies nearly forty pages of

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